

VIZ CRITIQUE 2

Bitcoin: Crypto Whales

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Bitcoin is the first decentralized cryptocurrency. In this graphic, we have a pie chart which represents all the addresses that own bitcoins. While several insights can be derived from this pie chart, there are several issues with the design of the visualization and its contents. We will discuss both in this visualization critique.

First, there is not any title, so the main information is not directly accessible. The blue colors representing 96.53% of BTC are highlighted in 6 different shapes. But these shapes are not uniform. In other words, the different categories have been made arbitrarily without following a clear pattern. Therefore, at first glance, 21.47% shapes looks like it is smaller than 20.47% BTC shape. It shows that both the scale and the representation of each category is both unclear and unprecise. The pattern should be made uniformly from the center of the pie; and highlight each BTC category as a piece of the whole pie. In that case, it would be easier to distinguish each category even if there is a small difference of relative BTC percentages.

Second, there are pink shapes that show that 95.89% of addresses owning 3.47 of BTC. However, the scale is not appropriate as 0.01% BTC representing 41.93% of the addresses is not depicted in the chart. Even though it is a small percentage, every category should be part of the chart. Also, all numbers have been rounded to the second decimal digits except for one value (0.00000748%). The number of significant figures should be the same for accuracy reasons.

Finally, both texts and subtitles are crowding the visualization. In my opinion, the shaded colors and texts are enough information with a proper title above the chart. However the addresses (%) should be represented in a legend on the side while only the percentage of bitcoins are represented in the colored pie chart.

To conclude, the goal of this visualization is to show that a small number of addresses hold a significant portion of the total supply of bitcoins. These addresses are referred to as whales in the cryptocurrency

community. Crypto whales are major actors in cryptocurrency. According to Binance academy, whales can include “individual investors, early adopters, cryptocurrency exchanges, investment funds, and other entities”. They therefore hold enough power to influence currency markets. Ultimately, the objective of the chart is to showcase the existence of crypto whales in the cryptocurrency world. Therefore, a pie chart is indeed a good choice of visualization with all the adjustments based on our critique. However, it should be noted that an interactive map would be a good recommendation as well in order to take into account constant exchanges in digital assets amongst addresses.

APPENDIX

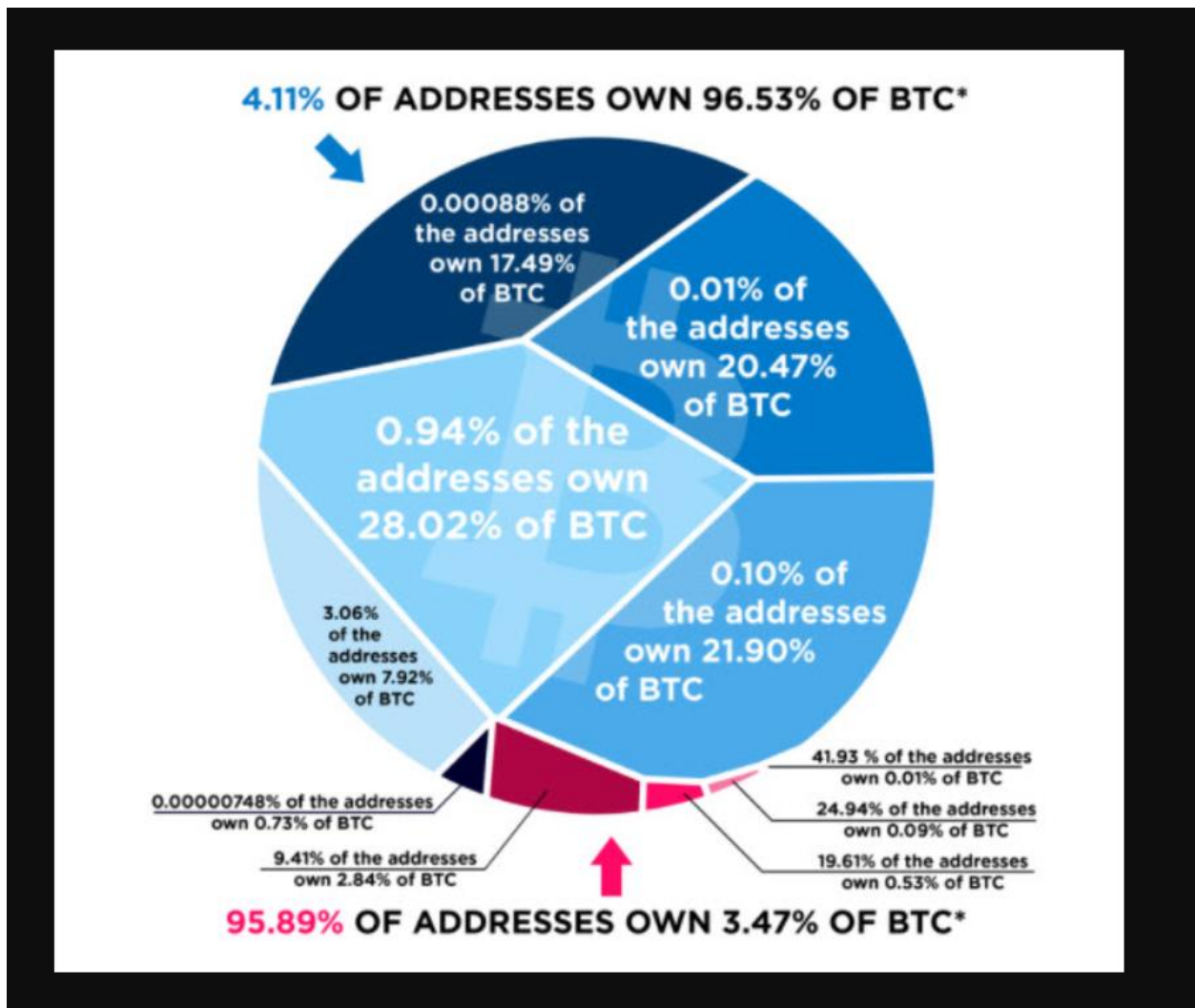


Figure 1: Bitcoin

REFERENCES

<https://www.binance.com/en>

<https://academy.binance.com/en/articles/what-are-crypto-whales-and-how-can-you-spot-them>